

CSCI 3921W - Social, Legal, and Ethical Issues in Computing

Human Values

List of human values often implicated in System Design:

1. **Welfare:** One's physical, material, and psychological well-being
2. **Ownership and property:** Right to possess an object (or information), use it, manage it, derive income from it, and bequeath it
3. **Privacy:** Right of an individual to determine what information about themselves can be communicated to others
4. **Freedom from bias:** Freedom from being unfairly treated based on pre-existing prejudice, partiality, or inclination
5. **Universal usability:** When any person can successfully use a system/technology/interface regardless of their physical, cognitive, cultural, or technical differences
6. **Trust:** When users place confidence in, rely on, or believe in the honesty, strength, or reliability of someone/something
7. **Autonomy:** One's ability to decide, plan, and act in ways that they believe will help them achieve their goals (self-direction, independent thought and action—choosing, creating, and exploring)
8. **Informed consent:** When a person receives clear, complete details about a procedure so they can make a voluntary choice to agree or refuse
9. **Accountability:** When the actions of a person, people, or institution may be traced uniquely to the person, people, or institution
10. **Courtesy:** Treating people with politeness and consideration
11. **Identity:** One's understanding of who they are over time, embracing both continuity and discontinuity over time
12. **Calmness:** Peaceful and composed psychological state, emotional balance
13. **Environmental sustainability:** Managing natural resources responsibly today so future generations still have what they need to survive and thrive

Friedman, B., & Hendry, D. G. (2026). Value sensitive design: Shaping technology with moral imagination. The MIT Press.